

The above steps (for both Plug and Play and non-Plug and Play devices) should normally solve the device conflict and get your hardware operational. However, if you still face problems with the device see the section *Using Device Manager* for further troubleshooting.

1.5.6 Using Device Manager

The Device Manager utility provides a graphical view of all the hardware installed on the computer along with their associated device drivers and resources. It also acts as a central point to change any hardware settings and update associated device drivers. To access Device Manager on Windows 9x/ME, right-click My Computer and select Properties. Select the Device Manager tab. On Windows 2000/XP, right-click My Computer, select Manage, and click Device Manager in the left pane.

Device Manager will list all the hardware in the PC in a tree structure. You can view devices by device-type or by connection-type. In either view, Device Manager will list the devices causing problems. The problem devices will be listed with any of the following symbols:

- A black exclamation mark (!) in a yellow circle means that the device has a problem. *Note:* A problem-state device could still be working.
- A red “X” means the device is disabled. That is, it is physically present in the computer and is consuming resources, but does not have a driver loaded.
- A blue “i” on a white circle means that the device’s “Use Automatic Settings” feature is not selected for the device, and that the resources were manually allocated, usually for non-Plug and Play devices. *Note:* This does not mean that the device is in a problem or disabled state.
- A green question mark (?) in Device Manager means that a compatible (and not the actual) driver for this device is installed, which makes it possible that all the functionality may not be available. *Note:* This applies only to Windows ME.
- A yellow question mark (?) with “Unknown Device” means that Windows has not recognised the device.